

According to size the planets of our solar system (in diameter) are as follows:

Jupiter – (142,984 km)
 Saturn – (120,536 km)
 Uranus – (51,118 km)
 Neptune – (49,528 km)
 Earth – (12,756 km)
 Venus – (12,104 km)
 Mars – (6,792 km)
 Mercury – (4,879 km)

3. Which one of the following is the heaviest planet of our Solar System ?

- (a) Jupiter (b) Venus
 (c) Pluto (d) Saturn

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (a)

The heaviest planet of our Solar System is Jupiter. Its diameter is 142984 kilometers and the average density is 1326 kg/m³. It is also notable that Jupiter is the planet of the solar system that is spinning on its axis with maximum speed.

4. Among the following which planet takes maximum time for one revolution around the Sun?

- (a) Earth (b) Jupiter
 (c) Mars (d) Venus

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Ans. (b)

In the given options Jupiter takes the maximum time i.e., 11.86 years to complete a revolution around the Sun, Earth takes 365.25 days, Mars takes 686.98 days and Venus takes 224.70 days.

5. The ring of Jupiter is composed of –

- (a) Silicates
 (b) Non-existent
 (c) Very thick and opaque
 (d) All the above

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (a)

The rings of Jupiter were first discovered by the Voyager 1 spacecraft in 1979. These rings are called “Jovian rings”. Jupiter’s rings are supposed to be made up of silicates and dust particles. Due to their sparse and almost transparent nature, it is hard to see them but their existence can’t be assumed to be improbable.

6. Which one of the following planets has the largest number of natural satellites or moons?

- (a) Jupiter (b) Mars (c) Saturn (d) Venus

I.A.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

Jupiter is the largest planet of our Solar System and also has the 2nd highest number of natural satellites or moons. At present total 95 moons or satellites of Jupiter have been discovered. When the question was asked Jupiter was the answer now Saturn is the correct answer, so option (c). The number of moons of other planet is as follows-

(Name of the planets)	(Total moons)
Mercury	0
Venus	0
Earth	1
Mars	2
Jupiter	95
Saturn	274
Uranus	28
Neptune	16

ix. The Saturn

*Saturn is the sixth planet from the sun and the second largest in the solar system. It has **274** natural satellites. ***Titan** is its largest satellite, having a diameter of 5150 km. ***Rhea** is the second largest natural satellite of Saturn having a diameter of 1528 km. *Other natural satellites of Saturn include Dione, Tethys, Mimas, Enceladus, Lapetus, Helene, Atlas, etc. It takes Saturn about 29.4 years to finish one revolution around the sun. *Saturn is also known as ‘**Globe of Gases**’ and ‘**Galaxy Like Planet**’. *Saturn is probably best known for the system of planetary rings that make it visually unique. Planetary rings A,B,D and E of the planet Saturn are visible from Earth. *The most prominent and most famous planetary rings in the solar system are those around Saturn, but the other three giant planets Jupiter, Uranus, and Neptune also have a ring system. *Saturn appears to the naked eye in the night sky as a bright, yellowish point of light. The duration of a day on Saturn is 10 hours 34 minutes and the planet's axial tilt is 26°70'. The average surface temperature of Saturn is –140°C. *The atmosphere of Saturn contains, hydrogen and helium. Trace amounts of methane, hydrogen Deuteride, ethane etc. Ammonia has also been detected in Saturn's atmosphere. *The magnetic field of Saturn's is 578 times as powerful that of our planet Earth. The Phoebe satellite of Saturn orbits Saturn opposite to Saturn's rotation. *The Cassini probe was sent on 15th October, 1997 to orbit the planet Saturn.